



INFRASTRUCTURE AND AMPLE FUNDING FOR RESEARCH WORK MAKE IIT-DELHI THE SECOND-BEST TECHNICAL COLLEGE

many ambitious projects, amongst them the Himalayan task of cleaning up the 2,510-km Ganges under The National Ganga River Basin Management Plan project. With as many as six other IITs, including Delhi and Chennai, joining hands with IIT-Kanpur, many believe this ambitious plan is no longer impossible.

The IITs in Chennai, Kharagpur, Mumbai, Roorkee and Guwahati are others in the Top 10 list with IIT-Kharagpur slipping two positions, from second to fourth. The only new entrant this year in the Top 10 is the National Institute of Technology, Surathkal, which has moved up from 11th to 10th position while the Institute of Technology, Banaras Hindu University, has slipped from eighth to 11th position.

After being on the top for two consecutive years, IIT-Delhi lost its Numero Uno position to IIT-Kanpur. Surendra Prasad, director, IIT-Delhi, believes that "IITs have remained good centres of technical learning because they have autonomy, best facilities and good funding for quality research work". About the faculty at IIT-Delhi, Prasad says the average age of 100 new faculty members is 32 years and most of them have been exposed to the best practices in the best educational institutes in the world. "The course contents are reviewed every year so as to adapt them to the current state of knowledge. Even the student's input is given due consideration," Prasad says. At IIT-Delhi, the emphasis is on research work with about Rs 100 crore earmarked for it every year.

The third slot in the Top 10 is occupied by IIT-Madras. Spread over a 250-hectare campus, canopied by lush green forest, it has a vision clear for itself: an academic institution in equilibrium with its social, ecological and economic environment striving continuously for excellence in education, research and technology. This vision

is exemplified by its Centre for Industrial Consultancy and Sponsored Research (IC and SR) that promotes interaction between the industry and institute. The institute has established itself as a premier centre for teaching, research and industrial consultancy in the country and currently has around 4,500 students, 460 teachers and 1,250 technical staff on its roll. To keep up with the best and the latest in the world of science and technology, the focus is on research and consultancy projects.

M.S. Ananth, director, IIT-Madras, says, "At times, our students fail to meet the expectations of the recruiting companies. We are working towards bridging this gap. IIT-Madras is very particular that its syllabus should cater to the needs of the companies and produce engineering graduates who match their expectations." A special placement cell at the campus ensures 100 per cent placement for hundreds of its engineering and MBA graduates, who are hired by some of the best like Tower Research Capital, Morgan Stanley, Goldman Sachs at an attractive compensation package. "Seventy per cent of our students who had registered for placements were hired by the best in the industry last year and this year too, 200 companies visited the campus," says Jayakumar, deputy registrar of training and placement at IIT-Madras.

Now there are seven IITs instead of original four that lead to the obvious apprehension: will growing numbers mean dilution in the quality of teaching? Prasad dispels such fears: "If the evolution process is good, there would be no dilution." IITs still remain potent instruments to change the world through scientific approach.

with Farzand Ahmed and Lakshmi Subramanian



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